

Yunxi Lai

Personal website: <https://yunxilai.github.io/> E-mail: laiyx29@mail2.sysu.edu.cn

Current affiliation: Zhongshan Ophthalmic Center, Sun Yat-sen University, China

EDUCATION

Ophthalmology | Zhongshan Ophthalmic Center, Sun Yat-sen University, China

Jul 2023–Jun 2026 **Doctor of Medicine (M.D.)** | Degree conferral expected December 2026

Thesis: Transformation from Clinical Data to Scientific Evidence Enabled by Large Language Models in Ophthalmology.

Sep 2020–Jun 2023 **Master of Medicine (M.M.)** | Licensed Physician

Standardized Residency Training Certificate in Ophthalmology

Thesis: Analyses of Routine Preoperative Blood Testing in Ocular Patients.

Clinical Medicine | Guangdong Medical University, China

Sep 2015–Jun 2020 **Bachelor of Medicine**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Founding Member **Development, Validation and Implementation of an Ophthalmic Large Language Model**

Jul 2023–Jun 2026 **-Defined ophthalmic evaluation benchmarks** for adapting a general-purpose LLM to ophthalmology and assessing its question-answering performance; co-authored an article published in *JAMA Ophthalmology* in 2024.

-Conceived its clinical application as a pre-consultation tool, designed an agent to actively elicit and document medical histories, and integrated it into existing outpatient workflows and hospital systems.

-Led full validation in a randomized controlled trial, including protocol and statistical analysis plan, ethics approval and trial registration, Python coding, statistical analysis in R and other trial operations; co-first-authored an article accepted by *npj Digital Medicine* on 30 August 2026.

-Coordinated multidisciplinary collaboration and dissemination across grant applications, intellectual property and public outreach, contributing to app deployment serving over 1.7 million people across four countries and to the project's selection as a Chinese digital health case study at the 2025 World Health Assembly.

Project Lead **Routine Preoperative Blood Testing in Ophthalmic Surgery**

Sep 2021–Jun 2023 **- Independently conducted a retrospective study** evaluating the necessity of routine preoperative blood testing and the applicability of *Choosing Wisely* recommendations to ophthalmic surgery in China.

- Analyzed and interpreted data from 102,542 patients, resulting in a first-author publication in the *British Journal of Ophthalmology* in 2024.

Clinical Researcher	Pediatric Cohort on Ocular Effects of Systemic Medications
Aug 2023–Mar 2026	- Coordinated a cross-institutional ophthalmology–pediatrics collaboration to monitor ocular adverse effects associated with systemic medications, spanning ethics approval, participant recruitment, ophthalmic examinations, and longitudinal data management. - Co-established and managed a prospective cohort of 600+ children, with an average of seven follow-up visits per participant. - Designed an LLM-assisted extraction method with active data-quality control to address inefficient longitudinal data extraction, converting discharge summaries into structured research variables; internally evaluated using retrospective longitudinal inpatient records.
Clinical Evaluator	Community-Based Ophthalmic Cohorts
Nov 2023–Mar 2025	- Explained test results, offered medical advice and collaborated with local healthcare providers.

TRANSFERABLE SKILLS

Clinical and Microsurgical Skills: Fine visuomotor coordination, perseverance, and attention to detail through hands-on emergency, inpatient and outpatient care, as well as surgical practice.

Research Design: Developed suitable study designs, with a solid grasp of protocol development, study operations, data collection, and statistical analysis.

Project Management and Interdisciplinary Teamwork: Managed timelines and deliverables with clinical, technical, and industry collaborators; communicated clearly, provided timely feedback, and aligned expectations.

Software Skills: Python and R programming; SPSS for statistical analysis; Codex and Visual Studio Code for coding and prototyping.

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent).

TEACHING & OUTREACH

Instructor	Pre-Rotation Training for First-Year Ophthalmology Residents
Aug 2024	- Prepared teaching materials and taught essential clinical procedures.
Contributor	Community Engagement & Outreach
2020-2025	- Led visual identity and art direction for the official launch of the ophthalmic LLM; contributed to video planning, content development and media promotion. - Planned and contributed to community activities, including Physicians' Day events, cultural performances and public eye-health screening initiatives.
Intermittent	

CONFERENCE PRESENTATION

May 2025	Evaluating GPT-4o in ophthalmic consultation and documentation: Bridging knowledge with clinical practice. (Poster) <i>Association for Research in Vision and Ophthalmology (ARVO) Annual Meeting, Salt Lake City, Utah, USA.</i>
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PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles: 7; First-author: 2

1. Luo, M. J.*, **Lai, Y.***, Wang, W.*, Bi, S., Jin, L., Chen, J., Wu, X., Lin, Z., Wang, J., Pang, J., Dongye, M., Wu, Y., Liu, Z., & Lin, H. (Accepted August 30, 2026. *Equal contribution) Standardized Pre-consultation by a Large Language Model Agent vs Ophthalmology Residents: A Randomized Clinical Trial. *npj Digital Medicine*.
2. **Lai, Y.**, Zeng, W., Liao, J., Yu, Y., Liu, X., & Wu, K. (2024) Retrospective Analyses of Routine Preoperative Blood Testing in a Tertiary Eye Hospital: Could Choosing Wisely Work in China? *British Journal of Ophthalmology*, 108(6), 897–902.
3. Luo, M. J., Pang, J., Bi, S., **Lai, Y.**, Zhao, J., Shang, Y., Cui, T., Yang, Y., Lin, Z., Zhao, L., Wu, X., Lin, D., Chen, J., & Lin, H. (2024) Development and Evaluation of a Retrieval-Augmented Large Language Model Framework for Ophthalmology. *JAMA Ophthalmology*, 142(9), 798–805.
4. Luo, M. J., Bi, S., Pang, J., Liu, L., Tsui, C. K., **Lai, Y.**, Chen, W., Yang, Y., Xu, K., Zhao, L., Jin, L., Lin, D., Wu, X., Chen, J., Chen, R., Liu, Z., Zou, Y., Yang, Y., Li, Y., & Lin, H. (2025) A Large Language Model Digital Patient System Enhances Ophthalmology History Taking Skills. *npj Digital Medicine*, 8(1), 502.
5. Liu, L., Hong, J., Wu, Y., Liu, S., Wang, K., Li, M., Zhao, L., Liu, Z., Li, L., Cui, T., Tsui, C. K., Xu, F., Hu, W., Yun, D., Chen, X., Shang, Y., Bi, S., Wei, X., **Lai, Y.**, Lin, D., Fu, Z., Deng, Y., Cai, K., Xie, Y., Cao, Z., Wang, D., Zhang, X., Dongye, M., Lin, H., & Wu, X. (2024) Digital ray: Enhancing Cataractous Fundus Images Using Style Transfer Generative Adversarial Networks to Improve Retinopathy Detection. *British Journal of Ophthalmology*, 108(10), 1423–1429.
6. Shang, Y., Lin, Y., Li, R., Shang, Y., Li, M., Zhao, L., Jin, L., Xu, A., Liu, D., Wu, Q., Luo, M., Pang, J., Bi, S., He, Y., Xu, M., Chen, X., Cao, Z., Yu, S., Zhao, J., **Lai, Y.**, Chen, W., & Lin, H. (2025) The Effectiveness of Large Language Models in Medical AI Research for Physicians: A Randomized Controlled Trial. *Cell Reports Medicine*, 6(12), 102469.
7. Li, Y., Cui, T., Lin, Z., Zhao, L., **Lai, Y.**, Yun, D., Lin, Z., Li, M., Huang, Y., Chen, S., Wang, D., Qiu, Y., Xu, Y., Yang, Y., Lin, D., Jiang, X., & Lin, H. (2026) Risk Factors and Critical Thresholds for Glucocorticoid-Induced Ocular Adverse Reactions in Children: Implications for Muscle and Neuromuscular Disease Management. *European Journal of Translational Myology*, 36(2).